

Nicholas Spyrison, Ph.D.

Statistician / Data Scientist

+1 (720) 765-1836

spyrison@gmail.com

nspyrison.netlify.app

github.com/nspyrison

linkedin.com/in/nspyrison



Career Summary

Statistician & Data Scientist with a background in complex physical and clinical systems. Proven track record in developing enterprise-level R packages and deploying scalable machine learning solutions. Expert in statistical testing and visualization with a focus on optimizing code performance and leading technical teams to accelerate project delivery.

Employment History

- 03/2023 – Present **Biostatistician, IFF – International Flavors and Fragrances,** Madison, WI.
- Produced, maintained, and interpreted 480 decay models of probiotic stability, informing pricing at a plant averaging \$460 Million USD annual sales
 - Automated colony plate counting with image analysis and predictions from machine learning models, improved accuracy while decreasing technician time
 - Interpretable Machine learning, statistical testing, high-throughput reporting, Shiny development, and data visualization consulting for >300 employees on-site
- 06/2022 – 01/2023 **Research Data Scientist, University of Queensland,** Clayton, VIC, Australia.
- Published analysis and figures on global kidney health outcomes from CDISC SDTM data structure
 - Worked agilely with SMEs, iterating by creating models predicting kidney health
- 07/2018 – 10/2022 **Research Officer, Monash University,** Clayton, VIC, Australia.
- Data Fluency Instructor:* Lead workshops (10-30 people) on statistical modeling, R, Python, PowerBI, and Git
 - Teaching Assistant:* Post-grad tutorials on high-dimensional data analysis, post-grad data visualization, and undergrad economic statistics
 - Research Officer:* Extract, transform, load, and analyze census and text data
- 12/2016 – 1/2018 **Business Intelligence Developer, CPI Card Group,** Denver, CO.
- SQL reporting; across 4 reporting platforms and 4 servers
 - Mentor junior teammates and improve query performance
 - Triage and transfer 30+ legacy reports to a modern reporting solution
 - Developed supply chain report tracking a cost reduction of more than \$4 Million USD
- 07/2015 – 10/2016 **Business Intelligence Developer, UDR Real Estate Investment Trust,** Denver, CO.
- Transition enterprise reporting from WebFOCUS to SQL reports (SSRS) – 10+ reports
- 11/2014 – 04/2015 **Business Intelligence Analyst, Heartland Financial USA,** Dubuque, IA.
- Financial reporting for internal and external audiences
- 02/2013 – 05/2014 **Delivery Analyst, IBM – International Business Machines,** Dubuque, IA.
- Automated ETL with VBA macros for about 0.5 FTE savings across the team
 - KPI reporting to teams and management
- 01/2010 – 08/2012 **Laboratory Technician, The Ames Laboratory & Iowa State University,** Ames, IA.

Authored Software (R Packages)

- 09/2022 **cheem** – Novel analysis and interactive visual for exploring ML interpretability [Link](#)
10/2020 **spinifex** – ggplot2-like API for composing and exporting animated projections [Link](#)

Education

- 02/2018 – 06/2022 **Ph.D. Information Technology & Statistics**, Monash University, Clayton, VIC,
Dimension reduction, interactive and animated data visualization, machine learning
Thesis: *Interactive and Dynamic Visualization of High-dimensional Data*.
 - Novel interoperability visualization methods for **Fit random forest models on several contemporary datasets** also shown to generalize to other models with **SVM and XGboost**
 - Utilized **SHAP and LIME local explanations** to explore local linear variable importance to understand large residuals in the models
 - Created **novel interactive animation** facilitating this exploration in a web app
 - **Authored R packages** on CRAN as free and open source work to improve reproducibility and contribute back to the community
- 08/2008 – 05/2012 **B.Sc. Statistics**, Iowa State University, minors in Physics and Mathematics, Ames, IA.

Technical Skills

Software	R, SQL, Python, Git, GitHub, L ^A T _E X, Excel, VBA
Packages	tidyverse, tidymodels, ggplot2, plotly, caret, keras, pandas, scikit-learn
Reporting	R Shiny, R Markdown/Quarto, SSRS, Tableau, PowerBI

Awards and Honors

- 03/2024 IFF Internal Recognition Award – Tier 1
 - Interactive modeling, visualization, and export of stability data
- 06/2022 Invited article for INFORM's OR/MS Tomorrow [Link](#)
- 04/2022 RStudio: March "Top 40" New CRAN Packages [Link](#)
- 05/2022 Monash Postgraduate Publication Award
- 10/2020 Melbourne Datathon 2020 – **1st place of several hundred entries** *Insights category* [Link](#)
 - *Changes to Victorian Intraday Electricity Demand Following COVID-19 Restrictions*
- 11/2018 ACEMS Impact and Engagement Award
- 07/2018 UseR2018 Datathon – 3rd place
 - Spatio temporal animated visualization of over 7 million avian sightings
- 2018 – 2022 Faculty Graduate Research Scholarship
- 2018 – 2022 Co-funded Monash Graduate Scholarship
- 05/2012 Nominated for Student Employee of the Year
- 05/2011 Nominated for Student Employee of the Year
- 05/2008 American Legion Award – High-honor recognition of character

Publications

Doctoral Thesis

- [1] Nicholas Spyrison. "Interactive and dynamic visualization of high-dimensional data". en. PhD thesis. Monash University, Mar. 2022. URL: https://github.com/nspyrison/thesis_ns/blob/master/docs/thesis_ns.pdf.

Journal Articles

- [2] Danyang Dai et al. "Omicron surge impact on acute kidney injury in ICU patients: A study using the ISARIC COVID-19 database". In: *PloS one* 20.11 (2025), e0336843.
- [3] Pedro Henrique Franca Gois et al. "AKI in Intensive Care Unit (ICU) Patients in the Omicron Surge: Insights from a Multinational Study: TH-PO1144". In: *Journal of the American Society of Nephrology* 35.10S (2024), pp. 10–1681.
- [4] Marina Wainstein et al. "WCN24-1193 VALIDATION OF THE EXTENDED KDIGO DEFINITION TO DIAGNOSE ACUTE KIDNEY INJURY IN A GENERAL HOSPITAL POPULATION USING THE MIMIC-IV DATASET". In: *Kidney International Reports* 9.4 (2024), S261–S262.
- [5] Anatoliy Gavrylov et al. "Association of Country Income Level With the Characteristics and Outcomes of Critically Ill Patients Hospitalized With Acute Kidney Injury and COVID-19". In: (2023).
- [6] Marina Wainstein et al. "Association of country income level with the characteristics and outcomes of critically ill patients hospitalized with acute kidney injury and COVID-19". In: *Kidney International Reports* (2023).
- [7] Nicholas Spyrisson, Dianne Cook, and Przemyslaw Biecek. "Exploring local explanations of nonlinear models using animated linear projections". In: *Computational Statistics* 40.2 (2025), pp. 1071–1095.
- [8] Nicholas Spyrisson, Dianne Cook, and Kim Marriott. "A Study on a User-Controlled Radial Tour for Variable Importance in High-Dimensional Data". In: *arXiv preprint, submitted to TVCG* (Dec. 2022). arXiv:2301.00077 [stat]. DOI: 10.48550/arXiv.2301.00077. URL: <http://arxiv.org/abs/2301.00077> (visited on 01/06/2023).
- [9] Stuart Lee et al. "The state-of-the-art on tours for dynamic visualization of high-dimensional data". en. In: *WIREs Computational Statistics* (Dec. 2021), p. 21. ISSN: 1939-0068. DOI: 10.1002/wics.1573. URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/pdf/10.1002/wics.1573> (visited on 12/10/2021).
- [10] Nicholas Spyrisson and Dianne Cook. "spinifex: an R Package for Creating a Manual Tour of Low-dimensional Projections of Multivariate Data". en. In: *The R Journal* 12.1 (2020), p. 243. ISSN: 2073-4859. DOI: 10.32614/RJ-2020-027. URL: <https://journal.r-project.org/archive/2020/RJ-2020-027/index.html> (visited on 10/16/2020).

Software (R Packages)

- [11] Nicholas Spyrisson. *cheem: Interactively Explore the Support of Local Explanations of a Model*. 2022. URL: <https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=cheem>.
- [12] Nicholas Spyrisson and Dianne Cook. *spinifex: Manual Tours, Manual Control of Dynamic Projections of Numeric Multivariate Data*. 2021. URL: <https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=spinifex>.

Conference Proceedings

- [13] Nicholas Spyrisson. "Animated Linear Projections". In: *Summer 2022*. INFORMS, May 2022.
- [14] Dianne Cook, Stuart Lee, and Nicholas Spyrisson. "A Showcase of New Methods for High Dimensional Data Viewing with Linear Projections and Sections". In: *Book of Abstracts*. International Federation of Classification Societies, 2022, p. 10.
- [15] Nicholas Spyrisson, Benjamin Lee, and Lonni Besançon. "'Is IEEE VIS *that* good?'" On key factors in the initial assessment of manuscript and venue quality". In: *IEEE AltVis Workshop*. type: article. July 2021. DOI: 10.31219/osf.io/65wm7. URL: <https://osf.io/65wm7/> (visited on 08/21/2021).
- [16] Madeleine Barrow, Jieyang Chong, and Nicholas Spyrisson. "Changes to Victorian Intraday Electricity Demand Following COVID-19 Restrictions". en. In: *Melbourne Datathon 2020, Insights category*. Oct. 2020, p. 4. URL: https://github.com/nspyrisson/melb_datathon2020/blob/master/_paper/paper.pdf (visited on 02/09/2022).
- [17] Nicholas Spyrisson. "spinifex: visualizing local structure of higher dimensions". en. In: Brisbane, Australia, 2018. URL: <https://user2018.r-project.org/poster/> (visited on 07/28/2020).